RISHABH RANJAN

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Education

Doctor of Philosophy (Ph.D.) in Computer Science *2023 – present*
Stanford University, co-advised by Prof. Jure Leskovec and Prof. Carlos Guestrin
Relevant courses: *Language Models from Scratch, Mining Massive Datasets, Machine Learning with Graphs*

Visiting Research Scholar *2022 – 2023*
Carnegie Mellon University, hosted by Prof. Zachary Lipton
Relevant courses: *Philosophical Foundations of Machine Intelligence*

Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech.) in Computer Science and Engineering *2018 – 2022*
Indian Institute of Technology Delhi CGPA 9.90/10, **Institute Rank 1**
Relevant courses: *Deep Learning, Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning, Artificial Intelligence, Data Mining, Linear Algebra, Probability and Stochastic Processes, Calculus, Language and Writing Skill*

Awards

- Selected for the **Wonderfest Science Envoy Program**, one of 12 PhDs from Stanford and UC Berkeley. *2026*
- **$150,000 in AWS Credits** to pretrain relational/tabular foundation models. *2026*
- **Amazon Core AI Fellowship** for 2 academic years, by nomination. *2025*
- **Certificate of Achievement** for a top leaderboard position in the course "Language Models from Scratch". *2024*
- **School of Engineering Fellowship**, awarded to select first-year PhD students at Stanford. *2023*
- **President's Gold Medal** for highest CGPA in the graduating batch at IIT Delhi. *2022*
- **Best Undergraduate Thesis Award** in Computer Science at IIT Delhi. *2022*
- All India Rank **154** in **Joint Entrance Examination (Advanced)** among 200,000+ qualified candidates. *2018*
- **Certificate of Merit** for excellent performance in the **Indian National Mathematical Olympiad**. *2017*

Publications

(* denotes equal contribution)

1. Liana Patel, Rishabh Ranjan, Ion Stoica, Matei Zaharia, Carlos Guestrin. **TokenGate: Adapting LLMs for Fast and Memory-Efficient Prefill with Learned Token Pruning.** *arXiv 2026.* (paper)

2. Rishabh Ranjan, Vignesh Kothapalli, Harshvardhan Agarwal, Charilaos Kanatsoulis, Roshan Upendra, Tom Palczewski, Carlos Guestrin, Jure Leskovec. **RT-J: Large-Scale Pretraining of Relational Transformers for Context-Efficient Predictions.** *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2026.* Early versions: *Foundation Models for Structured Data (FMSD) Workshop* and *Graph Foundation Models (GFM) Workshop at International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2026.* (paper)

3. Adrian Hayler, Klemens Flöge, Alan Arazi, Rishabh Ranjan, Jure Leskovec, Lennart Purucker, Frank Hutter, Noah Hollmann, and the Prior Labs Team. **Advancing Open and Reproducible Relational Learning: RelArena-α, TabPFN-Rel and RPI.** *arXiv 2026.* (paper)

4. Vignesh Kothapalli, Rishabh Ranjan, Valter Hudovernik, Vijay Prakash Dwivedi, Johannes Hoffart, Carlos Guestrin, Jure Leskovec. **PluRel: Synthetic Data unlocks Scaling Laws for Relational Foundation Models.** *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2026.* (paper)

5. Justin Gu, Rishabh Ranjan, Charilaos Kanatsoulis, Haiming Tang, Martin Jurkovic, Valter Hudovernik, Mark Znidar, Pranshu Chaturvedi, Parth Shroff, Fengyu Li, Jure Leskovec. **RelBench v2: A Large-Scale Benchmark and Repository for Relational Data.** *Navigating and Addressing Data Problems for Foundation Models (DATA-FM) Workshop at International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026.* (paper)

6. Rishabh Ranjan, Valter Hudovernik, Mark Znidar, Charilaos Kanatsoulis, Roshan Upendra, Mahmoud Mohammadi, Joe Meyer, Tom Palczewski, Carlos Guestrin, Jure Leskovec. **Relational Transformer: Toward Zero-Shot Foundation Models for Relational Data.** *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2026.* Early version: *AI for Tabular Data (AI4TD) Workshop at Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2025* (awarded **Oral**). (paper)

7. Rishabh Ranjan, Saurabh Garg, Mrigank Raman, Carlos Guestrin, Zachary Lipton. **Post-Hoc Reversal: Are We Selecting Models Prematurely?** *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024.* (paper)

8. Rishabh Ranjan*, Joshua Robinson*, Weihua Hu*, Kexin Huang*, Jiaqi Han, Alejandro Dobles, Matthias Fey, Jan E. Lenssen, Yiwen Yuan, Zecheng Zhang, Xinwei He, Jure Leskovec. **RelBench: A Benchmark for Deep Learning on Relational Databases.** *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024.* (paper)

9. Matthias Fey*, Weihua Hu*, Kexin Huang*, Jan Eric Lenssen*, Rishabh Ranjan*, Joshua Robinson*, Rex Ying, Jiaxuan You, and Jure Leskovec. **Position: Relational Deep Learning - Graph Representation Learning on Relational Databases.** *International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML) 2024.* (paper)

10. Yatin Nandwani*, Rishabh Ranjan*, Mausam, and Parag Singla. **A solver-free framework for scalable learning in neural ILP architectures.** *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2022.* (paper)

11. Rishabh Ranjan, Siddharth Grover, Sourav Medya, Venkatesan Chakaravarthy, Yogish Sabharwal, and Sayan Ranu. **GREED: A neural framework for learning graph distance functions.** *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2022.* (paper)

12. Rishabh Ranjan, Ishita Agrawal, and Subodh Sharma. **Exploiting epochs and symmetries in analysing MPI programs.** *International Conference on Automated Software Engineering (ASE) 2022.* (paper)

Academic Service

Reviewer for NeurIPS 2026, ICLR 2026, ICML 2025, NeurIPS 2023, WSDM 2023.